F Mich 9 Grammar notes

Irregular –OIR verbs in the present tense

- All of these verbs are irregular, but there is still a pattern to observe.

devoir *(to be obliged to, to owe)*		**pouvoir** *(to be able to, may/can)*	
je	*dois*	*je*	*peux*
tu	*dois*	*tu*	*peux*
il/elle/on	*doit*	*il/elle/on*	*peut*
nous	***de**vons*	*nous*	***pou**vons*
vous	***de**vez*	*vous*	***pou**vez*
ils/elles	*doivent*	*ils/elles*	*peuvent*

recevoir *(to receive)*		**savoir** *(to know)*	
je	*reçois*	*je*	*sais*
tu	*reçois*	*tu*	*sais*
il/elle/on	*reçoit*	*il/elle/on*	*sait*
nous	***rece**vons*	*nous*	***sa**vons*
vous	***rece**vez*	*vous*	***sa**vez*
ils/elles	*reçoivent*	*ils/elles*	*savent*

voir *(to see)*		**vouloir** *(to want to)*	
je	*vois*	*je*	*veux*
tu	*vois*	*tu*	*veux*
il/elle/on	*voit*	*il/elle/on*	*veut*
nous	***voy**ons*	*nous*	***voul**ons*
vous	***voy**ez*	*vous*	***voul**ez*
ils/elles	*voient*	*ils/elles*	*veulent*

REVISION: Irregular –IR verbs in the present tense

- **First 3 or 4 letter stem verbs**: have the first three or four three letters of the –IR infinitive as a stem and add the endings **–s,-s,-t,-ons,-ez,-ent.**
  - *dormir, mentir, partir, sentir, sortir*
- **-IR verbs using –ER endings**. Simply treat them as if they were –ER verbs.
  - *couvrir, découvrir, offrir, ouvrir, souffrir*
- **MOURIR**: *je meurs, tu meurs, il meurt, nous MOURons, vous MOURez, ils meurent*
- **VENIR**: *je viens, tu viens, il vient, nous VENons, vous VENez, ils viennent*

Where do adjectives go?

- The **vast majority of adjectives go after the noun** they describe
  - *un livre intéressant* *des femmes généreuses* *une idée géniale*
- Although the group of **adjectives that go before the noun** is small, they are the ones which are the most often required and should be learned carefully

joli	*grand*	*méchant*	*vieux*
beau	*excellent*	*jeune*	*petit*
large	*tout*	*court*	*meilleur*
tel	*gentil*	*haut*	*autre*
	long	*mauvais*	

- **Some adjectives' meaning changes** depending on their position

propre	*mes propres mains* **my own hands**	*les mains propres* **clean hands**
ancien	*un ancien combattant* **a former soldier**	*une église ancienne* **an old church**
dernier	*la dernière semaine* **the last week (of term etc)**	*la semaine dernière* **last week**
prochain	*la prochaine semaine* **the next week (in a series)**	*la semaine prochaine* **next week**
pauvre	*mon pauvre ami* **my poor friend (aah!)**	*mon ami pauvre* **my poor friend (no money)**
grand	*un grand soldat* **a great/famous soldier**	*un soldat grand* **a tall soldier**
cher	*mon cher ami* **my dear friend**	*un livre cher* **an expensive book**

More on the agreement of adjectives

- **The following adjectives are invariable and never agree**
  - *orange*, *argent* (**silver**), *marron* (**brown**), *chocolat*, *bon marché*
  - **ALL compound colours** – *bleu clair*, *vert foncé*, *rouge vif*
- **Some adjectives have a special MS form** (masculine singular) for words that begin with "h" or a vowel.
  - *un beau jour*, *un BEL acteur*, *deux beaux acteurs*, *deux belles actrices*
  - *beau* – **bel**, *nouveau* – **nouvel**, *vieux* – **vieil**, *fou* – **fol**